

Middle East Daily Brief

July 9, 2026

Executive summary

8 stories from 8 outlets (5 perspectives) over the reporting window. Leading the day: Trump declares Iran ceasefire 'over,' orders second day of US strikes and threatens naval blockade.

Top stories

1. **Trump declares Iran ceasefire 'over,' orders second day of US strikes and threatens naval blockade** *Al Jazeera, BBC, Bloomberg, CBS News, CNN, NPR, Reuters, The Guardian, The New York Times, The Times of Israel, The Washington Post, Time* · corroborated by 12 outlets Speaking from the NATO summit in Ankara, President Trump declared the three-week-old US-Iran memorandum of understanding 'over' after Iran attacked three commercial ships in the Strait of Hormuz, and US Central Command carried out strikes... <https://www.aljazeera.com/news/2026/7/8/trump-says-ceasefire-over-after-us-iran-trade-attacks>
2. **Khamenei's coffin carried into Najaf ahead of July 9 Mashhad burial; new leader Mojtaba stays hidden** *BBC, ABC News, Al Jazeera, Arab News, CNN, The Jerusalem Post, The New York Times, Time* · corroborated by 8 outlets The remains of Ayatollah Ali Khamenei were carried into the Imam Ali shrine in Najaf, Iraq on July 8, the penultimate stop of a seven-day state funeral that concludes with burial on July 9 at the Imam Reza shrine in his birthplace of... <https://www.bbc.co.uk/news/articles/cdej44kl70o>
3. **US strikes Iran's Kharg Island oil hub as Trump threatens seizure; Brent crude jumps 5.4%** *Bloomberg, Al Jazeera, CNBC, CNN, RFE/RL, Reuters, The Washington Post* · corroborated by 7 outlets Iranian state media reported explosions on Kharg Island, the terminal that handles the bulk of Iran's crude exports, after Trump said the US military had struck the island on July 7 and 'could take over' the facility. Washington reimposed... <https://www.rferl.org/a/iran-war-us-hormuz-oil-blockade-gulf-israel/33640284.html>
4. **UN warns Gaza aid is falling as crossings stay shut and a child is killed on average every day** *Middle East Eye, Al Jazeera, Middle East Monitor, The Guardian, The National, UN News* · corroborated by 6 outlets UN agencies warned that supplies entering Gaza fell again last month, to fewer than 42,000 pallets from about 46,600 in May, with most cargo crossings still closed and restrictions on specific goods in place. UNICEF said a child has been... <https://www.middleeasteye.net/>
5. **Gulf states condemn Iranian strikes on Bahrain as Araghchi phones Qatar urging de-escalation** *Arab News, Al Arabiya, Al Jazeera, Reuters, The Jerusalem Post* · corroborated by 5 outlets Kuwait strongly condemned Iranian attacks that targeted Bahrain on July 8, and Gulf governments said Tehran's strikes on commercial tankers and on Gulf states showed it was 'still unable to comply with the requirements of de-escalation'... <https://english.alarabiya.net/News/gulf>
6. **Lebanon weighs skipping Rome talks with Israel as IDF withdrawal from 'Yellow Line' stalls** *The Jerusalem Post, Al Jazeera, Naharnet, The Times of Israel* · corroborated by 4 outlets Lebanese

officials signaled Beirut may skip planned talks in Rome with Israel unless the IDF fulfills pledged withdrawals from several points north and south of the 'Yellow Line' in southern Lebanon. Israeli Northern Command officials... <https://www.jpost.com/middle-east>

By theme

Israel – Gaza & the Palestinians

- **UN warns Gaza aid is falling as crossings stay shut and a child is killed on average every day** – Middle East Eye, Al Jazeera, Middle East Monitor, The Guardian, The National, UN News <https://www.middleeasteye.net/>

Iran & the US

- **Trump declares Iran ceasefire 'over,' orders second day of US strikes and threatens naval blockade** – Al Jazeera, BBC, Bloomberg, CBS News, CNN, NPR, Reuters, The Guardian, The New York Times, The Times of Israel, The Washington Post, Time <https://www.aljazeera.com/news/2026/7/8/trump-says-ceasefire-over-after-us-iran-trade-attacks>
- **Khamenei's coffin carried into Najaf ahead of July 9 Mashhad burial; new leader Mojtaba stays hidden** – BBC, ABC News, Al Jazeera, Arab News, CNN, The Jerusalem Post, The New York Times, Time <https://www.bbc.co.uk/news/articles/cdejj44kl70o>
- **US strikes Iran's Kharg Island oil hub as Trump threatens seizure; Brent crude jumps 5.4%** – Bloomberg, Al Jazeera, CNBC, CNN, RFE/RL, Reuters, The Washington Post <https://www.rferl.org/a/iran-war-us-hormuz-oil-blockade-gulf-israel/33640284.html>
- **EU aviation regulator tells airlines to avoid Iran, Iraq and Lebanon airspace until August 31** – Al Arabiya, Al Jazeera, Reuters, The Times of Israel <https://english.alarabiya.net/News/middle-east>

Lebanon & Hezbollah

- **Lebanon weighs skipping Rome talks with Israel as IDF withdrawal from 'Yellow Line' stalls** – The Jerusalem Post, Al Jazeera, Naharnet, The Times of Israel <https://www.jpost.com/middle-east>

Gulf & Arabian Peninsula

- **Gulf states condemn Iranian strikes on Bahrain as Araghchi phones Qatar urging de-escalation** – Arab News, Al Arabiya, Al Jazeera, Reuters, The Jerusalem Post <https://english.alarabiya.net/News/gulf>

Israel – politics & society

- **Netanyahu says he and Trump 'see eye to eye' on Iran as Hegseth weighs Turkey F-35 sale** – The Times of Israel, CNN, The Jerusalem Post <https://www.timesofisrael.com/liveblog-july-8-2026/>

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